

free WiFi user's screen. Such "sniffer software" intercepts the traffic between the router and device to filter out important information. These unsecured networks can also be used to plant malware in another network user's device if file-sharing has been enabled. Another popular method used by hackers is to set up rogue Wi-Fi hotspots with generic names, hence fooling unassuming users into connecting to these networks, following which their information can easily be collected.

Considering that necessity generally overrides such concerns many times, one can take certain basic and inexpensive steps to avoid any mishandling of personal information. If you find yourself needing to connect to public Wi-Fi networks frequently, it'll be worthwhile to invest in a Virtual Private Network (VPN). A VPN is a private network that enables users to send and receive data across shared or public networks as if their computing devices were directly connected to the private network. A bonus is that VPNs will allow you to access blocked and filtered content, hence providing a better internet experience. Most trustworthy VPN services require a monthly subscription of a few hundred rupees, and are certainly worth the expenditure if you're regularly using public networks. Some great VPNs in India are Private Internet Access, Torguard, CyberGhost VPN and TunnelBear, which cost between Rs. 400-800/month. If your usage of public networks is infrequent and you do not need to visit websites with confidential personal information, credit card data and important emails, enabling the "Always Use [HTTPS](#)" option, or simply installing browser add-ons like "[HTTPS](#) Everywhere" is useful and does the trick. Another useful tip is to turn off device sharing on such networks, so that malicious devices cannot access yours, and enabling the Firewall, as discussed before.

"What happens if I click on this pop-up..."

Once you're on the internet, a lot of what happens to your computing device is in your hands. How you deal with spurious links, banners and pop-ups will determine the health of your device.

It goes without saying that many of the banners, ads, pop-ups and emails that you view and receive on the internet are scams. Many of these popups, which look like legitimate posts coming from your email provider, favourite social media websites or e-commerce sites are generally spurious and fake versions. Many a times these pop-ups pretend to find viruses and malware on your device and "report" them. Entering your personal details while executing any kind of operations on these imposter websites